year 2012 with a turnover of Rs 1,32,899 crore and a PAT of Rs 4,948 crore. Since 2002, when it became mandatory to maintain consolidated accounts, Tata Steel's revenue had risen eighteen times and the PAT twenty-six times by when Ratan left the corner office.

Thanking all the shareholders and the staff across the world in the AGM address, Ratan concluded by hoping that the company would continue to be what it had become—'one of the most cost-efficient steel producers—as the supplier of choice in the markets it serves—by differentiating itself, its products, its processes and its service to the customer'.

There were many problems that the steel giant had had to face in its quest to become a recognized global steel manufacturer. Corus's UK operations came with its extreme challenges, while the Dutch operations were a star inclusion in the Tata family. As many analysts had opined, large takeovers are usually followed by a phase of consolidation. And how it would be managed was left in the hands of Ratan's successors. It takes imagination, courage and enterprise to build large empires or organizations, but it is also a challenge to build on the gains made.

When Ratan had taken over the company, it had a turnover of Rs 3,352 crore. It had grown by 3,865 per cent from 1993 (standalone turnover) to 2012 (consolidated turnover). He hung up his boots with a sense of satisfaction and hope for the future, not unduly perturbed by the downturn in the Western market.